

# BADMINTON

## SATWIKSAIRAJ RANKIREDDY AND CHIRAG SHETTY

***Satwiksairaj Rankireddy, who hails from Andhra Pradesh, and Maharashtra's Chirag Shetty are the reigning Asian Games champions in the men's doubles competition.*** The duo has a strong chance of making it back-to-back gold medals.

Ranked fifth in the world, they have produced some solid results this year despite frequent injuries. They reached the final at the Thailand Open and won the title at the Singapore Open. In the semifinals in Singapore, the pair recorded its maiden win over Korean World No. 1 Kim Won Ho and Seo Seung Jae.

Their tall stature — both have a height of six feet and above — and powerful jump-smashes make them an intimidating presence on the court.

Apart from managing their fitness issues, Satwik and Chirag's biggest task at the Asian Games will be to make it past old rivals Liang Wei Keng and Wang Chang if there is a possible clash. The newly crowned world champions have beaten the Indians twice this season, but Satwik and Chirag have shown in the past that Liang and Wang are not invincible.

MEN'S  
DOUBLES

